

Molossus rufus

Black mastiff bat



Length 2¾–4 in
(7–10 cm)
Tail 1½–2 in
(4–5 cm)
Weight 1½–1⅞ oz
(30–40 g)
Location Mexico to C.
South America, Trinidad
Social unit Group
Status Least concern



Medium in size, mastiff bats are also called free-tailed velvety bats for their short, soft fur. This species often roosts in buildings and feeds on

insects attracted to streetlights. It is more active around dawn and dusk than most bats, and roosts in the middle of the night as well as by day. Huge numbers of insects are stored in its cheek pouches and only chewed and swallowed on return to the roost.



Plecotus auritus

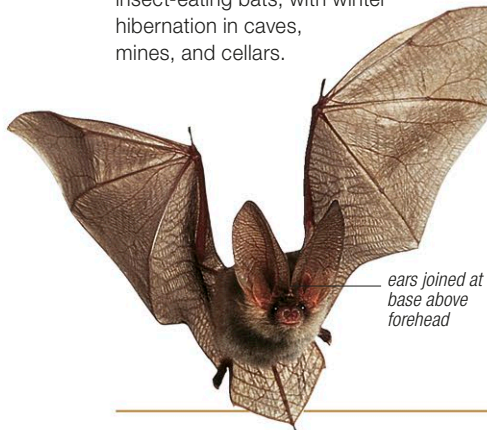
Brown long-eared bat



Length 1½–2 in
(4–5 cm)
Tail 1½–2 in
(4–5 cm)
Weight ¼–½ oz
(7–14 g)
Location Europe, C. Asia
Social unit Group
Status Least concern



A compact face and relatively large ears identify the 19 *Plecotus* species of Old World bats. The fur is usually brownish gray, the face darker. This species takes a variety of insects, including moths and beetles, carrying the meal to a perch to eat. Its other habits are typical of small, insect-eating bats, with winter hibernation in caves, mines, and cellars.



Vespertilio murinus

Particoloured bat



Length 2–2½ in
(5–6.5 cm)
Tail 1½–2 in
(3.5–4.5 cm)
Weight ¾–¾ oz
(10–25 g)
Location Europe to W., C.,
and E. Asia
Social unit Group
Status Least concern



Distinctive coloration of almost black wings and face, pale cream fur below, and brown back hairs tipped with white give the particoloured bat its various

Antrozous pallidus

Pallid bat



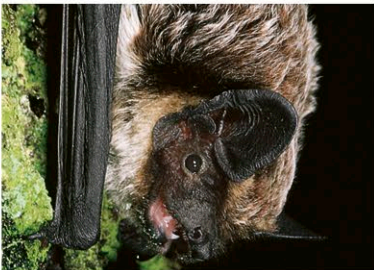
Length 2½–3 in
(5.5–8 cm)
Tail 1½–2¼ in
(3.5–5.5 cm)
Weight ½–1⅞ oz
(14–30 g)
Location W. North
America to Mexico, Cuba
Social unit Group
Status Least concern





This medium-sized, pig-nosed, pale bat tolerates a range of dry habitats, from grassland to scrubby desert and even the intense heat of California's Death Valley. It detects victims by the sounds they make, consuming beetles, crickets, spiders, centipedes, scorpions, lizards, and pocket mice. The pallid bat utters piercing directive cries audible to humans as it "rallies," flying in groups to locate its roost in rocky outcrops, trees, or attics.

common names, including frosted bat. It roosts by day in small crevices in cliffs or buildings. In late fall, males fly high near steep rock faces and tall buildings, their courting calls resembling the shrill whine of a high-speed metal grinder.



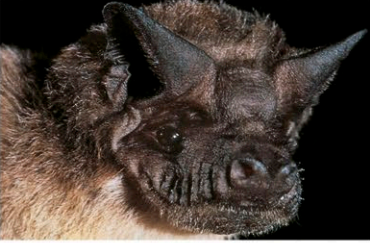
Mops condylurus

Angolan free-tailed bat



Length 2¾–3 in
(7–8.5 cm)
Tail 1½ in
(4 cm)
Weight ¾–1¼ oz
(18–35 g)
Location W., C., E., and
southern Africa
Social unit Group
Status Least concern





Common and widespread from deserts to rain forests, this bat has a long, mouse-like, "free" tail, not enclosed by the tail membranes. It displays the typical bat habit of emerging from its daytime roost in noisy, flapping groups, thereby lessening each individual's risk of being caught by a predator, such as an owl, hawk, or snake. It hunts flying insects, eating them in the air and dropping hard parts such as the legs.

Natalus stramineus

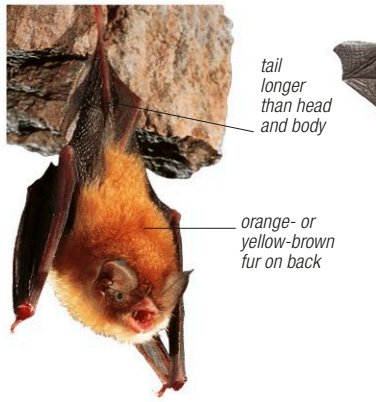
Lesser Antilles funnel-eared bat



Length 1½–1¾ in
(4–4.5 cm)
Tail 1¾–2 in
(4.7–5.2 cm)
Weight ⅓–¾ oz
(3–5 g)
Location Caribbean
Social unit Group
Status Least concern



There are around 8 species of tropical American funnel-eared bats. Tiny and delicate with rounded ears, they have soft, woolly fur and a tail joined by flight membranes to the legs. The Lesser Antilles funnel-eared bat has a rapid, agile flight, almost like a butterfly. It eats small flying insects and roosts by day in caves.



Otonycteris hemprichii

Hemprich's long-eared bat



Length 2½–2¾ in
(6–7 cm)
Tail 1½–2 in
(4.7–4.9 cm)
Weight 1⅞–1⅞ oz
(20–30 g)
Location N. Africa to
W. Asia
Social unit Group
Status Least concern





Also known as the desert long-eared bat, this is one of the few bat species content in dry, barren habitats. During periods of harsh weather, such as drought, it probably enters a period of hibernation-like inactivity. Its spectacular ears are 1½ in (4 cm) long and often held almost horizontally in flight, such as when swooping onto the ground for insects and spiders. This bat roosts by day in groups of at least 20 in a crevice, cave, or building.

Myotis daubentonii

Daubenton's bat



Length 1½–2½ in
(4–6 cm)
Tail 1–2 in
(2.5–5 cm)
Weight ¾–¾ oz
(5–15 g)
Location Europe to N. and
E. Asia
Social unit Group
Status Least concern



Daubenton's is one of about 111 species in the widespread bat genus *Myotis*—small brown or mouse-eared bats. It flutters 3¼–6½ ft (1–2 m) above water to catch flying insects by mouth or in the pouch of its curled wing or tail membrane—hence its other name of water bat. It also skims the surface and grabs small fish in its large back feet. By day, this bat roosts in trees, buildings, old walls, and bridges. It flies up to 180 miles (300 km) to its winter hibernation site in a cave or mine.

